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Methods and apparatus for processing a substrate

Abstract

Methods and apparatus for processing a substrate are provided herein. For example, an apparatus for processing a substrate comprises a top delivery gas nozzle configured to direct process gas toward a substrate support surface of a substrate support and a side delivery gas nozzle configured to direct the process gas toward a side surface of the substrate support, a first gas line connected to the top delivery gas nozzle, a second gas line connected to the side delivery gas nozzle, and a plurality of valves connected to the first gas line and the second gas line for providing process gas to the processing volume of the processing chamber, and a first orifice flow restrictor or a first needle valve connected to the first gas line or a second orifice flow restrictor or a second needle valve connected to the second gas line.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to a methods and apparatus for processing a substrate, and more particularly, to methods and apparatus configured to manage

process gas flow to a processing volume of a processing chamber during operation.

BACKGROUND

(2) Plasma processing apparatus including a plasma processing chamber, a gas source that supplies process gas into the processing chamber, and an energy source that produces plasma from the process gas are known. For example, plasma processing can include one or more plasma deposition processes (e.g., physical vapor deposition, chemical vapor deposition, atomic layer deposition, etc.), one or more plasma etch processes, or one or more other plasma processes. Typically, during plasma processing one or more process gases are introduced into a processing volume of a processing chamber. For example, with respect to plasma etch processes, multiple process gases, e.g., octafluorocyclobutane (C.sub.4F.sub.8), oxygen (O.sub.2), sulfur hexafluoride (SF.sub.6), etc., can be introduced into the processing chamber using a fast-switching process during etch cycles. Such processes, however, can be quite costly as multiple fast response-time atomic layer deposition (ALD) valves are required to achieve fast-switching between the process gases while maintaining the required flow parameters, such as uniform mass flow rates and pressure during the fast-switching.

SUMMARY

(3) Methods and apparatus for processing a substrate are provided herein. In some embodiments, an apparatus for processing a substrate comprises a processing chamber comprising a chamber body and a lid, a top delivery gas nozzle extending through the lid and configured to direct process gas toward a substrate support surface of a substrate support disposed within a processing volume of the processing chamber, a side delivery gas nozzle extending through the chamber body and configured to direct the process gas toward a side surface of the substrate support, a first gas line connected to the top delivery gas nozzle, a second gas line connected to the side delivery gas nozzle, and a plurality of valves connected to the first gas line and the second gas line for providing process gas to the processing volume of the processing chamber, and at least one of a first orifice flow restrictor or a first needle valve connected to the first gas line or a second orifice flow restrictor or a second needle valve connected to the second gas line.

(4) In accordance with at least some embodiments, a method of processing a substrate comprises supplying a process gas, via a first gas line connected to a top delivery gas nozzle, a second gas line connected to a side delivery nozzle, and a plurality of valves connected to the first gas line and the second gas line, to a processing volume of a process chamber and controlling a gas flow rate of the process gas through at least one of the top delivery gas nozzle or the side delivery nozzle via at least one of a first orifice flow restrictor or a first needle valve connected to the first gas line or a second orifice flow restrictor or a second needle valve connected to the second gas line.

(5) Other and further embodiments of the present disclosure are described below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure, briefly summarized above and discussed in greater detail below, can be understood by reference to the illustrative embodiments of the disclosure depicted in the appended drawings. However, the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of the disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional view of a processing chamber suitable for etching in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some

embodiments of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(10) FIG. 9 is a flowchart of a method for processing a substrate in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(11) FIGS. 10A-10C are diagrams of process zones of a substrate processed in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(12) To facilitate understanding, identical reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate identical elements that are common to the figures. The figures are not drawn to scale and may be simplified for clarity. Elements and features of one embodiment may be beneficially incorporated in other embodiments without further recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) Embodiments of methods and apparatus configured to manage process gas flow to a processing volume of a processing chamber during operation are provided herein. For example, in at least some embodiments, apparatus may comprise a top delivery gas nozzle, a side delivery gas nozzle, and one or more orifice flow restrictors and/or needle valves connected to one or more separate gas lines that connect to the top delivery gas nozzle and the side delivery gas nozzle. The methods and apparatus described herein use a reduced number of fast-response time ALD valves—when compared to conventional methods and apparatus—while effectively managing process gas flow parameters, such as uniform mass flow rates and pressure to different sections of a processing volume during fast-switching, thus providing a more cost-effective method to perform fast-switching during operation.

(14) FIG. 1 is a sectional view of one example of a processing chamber **100** suitable for performing an etch process in accordance with the present disclosure. Suitable processing chambers that may be adapted for use with the teachings disclosed herein include, for example, processing chambers available from Applied Materials, Inc. of Santa Clara, CA. Other processing chambers (PVD, CVD, ALD, etc.) may be adapted to benefit from one or more of the methods of the present disclosure.

(15) The processing chamber **100** includes a chamber body **102** and a lid **104** which enclose a processing volume **106**. The chamber body **102** is typically fabricated from aluminum, stainless steel or other suitable material. The chamber body **102** generally includes sidewalls **108** and a bottom **110**. A substrate support access port (not shown) is generally defined in a sidewall **108** and is selectively sealed by a slit valve to facilitate entry and egress of a substrate **103** from the processing chamber **100**. An exhaust port **126** is defined in the chamber body **102** and couples the processing volume **106** to a pump system **128**, which can also function as a purge station. The pump system **128** generally includes one or more pumps and throttle valves utilized to evacuate and regulate the pressure of the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**. In embodiments, the pump system **128** is configured to maintain the pressure inside the processing volume **106** at operating pressures typically between about 1 mTorr to about 500 mTorr, between about 5 mTorr to about 100 mTorr, or between about 5 mTorr to 50 mTorr depending upon process needs.

(16) In some embodiments, the processing chamber **100** may utilize capacitively coupled RF

energy for plasma processing, or in some embodiments, processing chamber **100** may use inductively coupled RF energy for plasma processing. In some embodiments, a remote plasma source **177** may be optionally coupled to a gas panel to facilitate dissociating gas mixture from a remote plasma prior to entering the processing volume **106** for processing. In some embodiments, a RF source power **143** is coupled through a matching network **141** to the showerhead assembly **130**. The RF source power **143** typically can produce up to about 5000 W for example between about 200 W to about 5000 W, or between 1000 W to 3000 W, or about 1500 W and optionally at a tunable frequency in a range from about 50 kHz to about 200 MHz.

(17) In embodiments, a gas panel **158** is coupled to the processing chamber **100** and includes one or more mass flow controllers **157** to provide one or more process and/or cleaning gases to the processing volume **106**. In the example depicted in FIG. 1, inlet ports **132'**, **132''**, **132'''** are provided in the lid **104** to allow gases to be delivered from the gas panel **158** to the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**. In embodiments, the gas panel **158** is adapted to provide oxygen (O.sub.2), an inert gas such as argon, helium (or other noble gas), or a gas mixture such as carbon tetrafluoride (CF.sub.4), octafluorocyclobutane, or perfluorocyclobutane (C.sub.4F.sub.8), trifluoromethane (CHF.sub.3), sulfur hexafluoride (SF.sub.6), silicon tetrafluoride or tetrafluorosilane (SiF.sub.4), etc., through the inlet ports **132'**, **132''**, **132'''** and into the interior volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**. In at least some embodiments, the process gas provided from the gas panel **158** includes at least a process gas including an oxidizing agent such as oxygen gas. In embodiments, the process gas including an oxidizing agent may further comprise an inert gas such as argon or helium. In some embodiments, the process gas includes a reducing agent such as hydrogen and may be mixed with an inert gas such as argon, or other gases such as nitrogen or helium. In some embodiments, a chlorine gas may be provided alone, or in combination with at least one of nitrogen, helium an inert gas such as argon. Non-limiting examples of oxygen containing gas includes one or more of O.sub.2, carbon dioxide (CO.sub.2), H.sub.2O, nitrous oxide (N.sub.2O), nitrogen dioxide (NO.sub.2), ozone (O.sub.3), and the like. Non-limiting examples of nitrogen containing gas includes N.sub.2, ammonia (NH.sub.3), and the like. Non-limiting examples of chlorine containing gas includes hydrogen chloride (HCl), chlorine (Cl.sub.2), carbon tetrachloride (CCl.sub.4), and the like. In embodiments, a showerhead assembly **130** is coupled to an interior surface **114** of the lid **104**. The showerhead assembly **130** includes a plurality of apertures that allow the gases flowing through the showerhead assembly **130** from the inlet ports **132'**, **132''**, **132'''** into the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100** in a predefined distribution across the surface of the substrate **103** (e.g., center, middle, side) being processed in the processing chamber **100**.

(18) A In one embodiment, the showerhead assembly **130** is configured with a plurality of zones that allow for separate control of gas flowing into the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**. In the example illustrated in FIG. 1, the showerhead assembly **130** comprises a top delivery gas nozzle **135** that is configured to direct the process gas toward a substrate support surface of the substrate support **148**. Accordingly, the top delivery gas nozzle **135** includes a center flow outlet **134** configured for center flow control and a middle flow outlet **136** configured for middle flow control that are separately coupled to the gas panel **158** through corresponding inlet ports **132'**, **132''**. Additionally, one or more side delivery gas nozzles can extend through the chamber body **102** and can be configured to direct the process gas toward a side surface of the substrate support **148**. For example, in at least some embodiments, a side delivery gas nozzle **133** can include side flow outlets **137** configured for side flow control that is separately coupled to the gas panel **158** through the inlet port **132'''**. Unlike the center flow outlet **134** and the middle flow outlet **136** which are disposed on the lid **104**, the side flow outlets **137** are disposed along an interior of the sidewalls **108** of the processing chamber in a generally circular manner. The center flow outlet **134** and the middle flow outlet **136** are configured to provide process gas to substantially etch a center zone and a middle zone (e.g., between the center and an edge) of a

substrate, and the side flow outlets **137** that are disposed along are configured to provide process gas to substantially etch an edge area (or perimeter) of a substrate, as described in greater detail below.

(19) In some embodiments, the substrate support **148** is disposed in the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100** below the gas distribution assembly such as showerhead assembly **130**. The substrate support **148** holds the substrate **103** during processing. The substrate support **148** generally includes a plurality of lift pins (not shown) disposed therethrough that are configured to lift the substrate **103** from the substrate support **148** and facilitate exchange of the substrate **103** with a robot (not shown) in a conventional manner. An inner liner **118** may closely circumscribe the periphery of the substrate support **148**.

(20) In one embodiment, the substrate support **148** includes a mounting plate **162**, a base **164** and an electrostatic chuck **166**. The mounting plate **162** is coupled to the bottom **110** of the chamber body **102** includes passages for routing utilities, such as fluids, power lines and sensor leads, among others, to the base **164** and the electrostatic chuck **166**. The electrostatic chuck **166** comprises the clamping electrode **180** for retaining the substrate **103** below showerhead assembly **130**. The electrostatic chuck **166** is driven by a chucking power source **182** to develop an electrostatic force that holds the substrate **103** to the chuck surface, as is conventionally known. Alternatively, the substrate **103** may be retained to the substrate support **148** by clamping, vacuum, or gravity.

(21) A base **164** or electrostatic chuck **166** may include heater **176** (e.g., at least one optional embedded heater), at least one optional embedded isolator **174** and a plurality of conduits **168**, **170** to control the lateral temperature profile of the substrate support **148**. The plurality of conduits **168**, **170** are fluidly coupled to a fluid source **172** that circulates a temperature regulating fluid therethrough. The heater **176** is regulated by a power source **178**. The plurality of conduits **168**, **170** and heater **176** are utilized to control the temperature of the base **164**, heating and/or cooling the electrostatic chuck **166** and ultimately, the temperature profile of the substrate **103** disposed thereon. The temperature of the electrostatic chuck **166** and the base **164** may be monitored using a plurality of temperature sensors **190**, **192**. The electrostatic chuck **166** may further include a plurality of gas passages (not shown), such as grooves, that are formed in a substrate support pedestal supporting surface of the electrostatic chuck **166** and fluidly coupled to a source of a heat transfer (or backside) gas, such as helium (He). In operation, the backside gas is provided at controlled pressure into the gas passages to enhance the heat transfer between the electrostatic chuck **166** and the substrate **103**. In embodiments, the temperature of the substrate may be maintained at 20 degrees Celsius to 450 degrees Celsius, such as 100 degrees Celsius to 300 degrees Celsius, or 150 degrees Celsius to 250 degrees Celsius.

(22) In one embodiment, the substrate support **148** is configured as a cathode and includes a clamping electrode **180** that is coupled to the RF bias power source **184** and RF bias power source **186**. The RF bias power source **184** and RF bias power source **186** are coupled between the clamping electrode **180** disposed in the substrate support **148** and another electrode, such as the showerhead assembly **130** or (lid **104**) of the chamber body **102**. The RF bias power excites and sustains a plasma discharge formed from the gases disposed in the processing region of the chamber body **102**.

(23) Still referring to FIG. 1, in some embodiments the RF bias power source **184** and RF bias power source, **186** are coupled to the clamping electrode **180** disposed in the substrate support **148** through a matching circuit **188**. The signal generated by the RF bias power source **184** and RF bias power source **186** is delivered through matching circuit **188** to the substrate support **148** through a single feed to ionize the gas mixture provided in the plasma processing chamber such as processing chamber **100**, thus providing ion energy necessary for performing an etch deposition or other plasma enhanced process. The RF bias power source **184** and RF bias power source **186** are generally capable of producing an RF signal having a frequency of from about 50 kHz to about 200

MHz and a power between about 0 Watts and about 500 Watts, 1 Watt (W) to about 100 W, or about 1 W to about 30 W. An additional bias power **189** may be coupled to the clamping electrode **180** to control the characteristics of the plasma.

(24) A controller **150** is coupled to the processing chamber **100** to control operation of the processing chamber **100**. The controller **150** includes a central processing unit **152**, a memory **154** (e.g., a nontransitory computer readable storage medium), and a support circuit **156** utilized to control the process sequence and regulate the gas flows from the gas panel **158**. The central processing unit **152** may be any form of general-purpose computer processor that may be used in an industrial setting. The software routines (e.g., executable instructions stored) can be stored in the memory **154**, such as random-access memory, read only memory, floppy, or hard disk drive, or other form of digital storage. The support circuit **156** is conventionally coupled to the central processing unit **152** and may include cache, clock circuits, input/output systems, power supplies, and the like. Bi-directional communications between the controller **150** and the various components of the processing chamber **100** are handled through numerous signal cables.

(25) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. For example, the gas flow delivery system **200** is configured for use with the gas panel **158** of the processing chamber **100**. As noted above, the gas panel **158** includes the top delivery gas nozzle **135** that includes the center flow outlet **134** and the middle flow outlet **136** and the side delivery gas nozzle **133** that includes the side flow outlets **137**. For illustrative purposes, eight side flow outlets **137** of the side delivery gas nozzle **133** are shown aligned along a vertical axis. As noted above, however, in an assembled configuration the eight side flow outlets **137** would normally be disposed in a generally circular manner along the interior of the sidewalls **108** (e.g., surrounding the substrate support **148**).

(26) A first gas line **202** is connected to the top delivery gas nozzle **135** and a second gas line **204** is connected to the side delivery gas nozzle **133**. The first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** are also connected to each other via a third gas line **203** at a location prior to process gas entering a first orifice flow restrictor **206** (or a first needle valve) connected to the first gas line **202** or a second orifice flow restrictor **208** (or the second needle valve) connected to the second gas line **204**. The first orifice flow restrictor **206** and the second orifice flow restrictor **208** are configured to restrict or maintain a flow of the process gas to a predetermined flow rate. For example, the predetermined flow rate can be about 300 sccm to about 3000 sccm. Additionally, the first orifice flow restrictor **206** and the second orifice flow restrictor **208** are set to the predetermined flow rate and cannot be adjusted in-situ, e.g., during operation.

(27) Additionally, a plurality of valves **201** (e.g., fast closing valves) are connected to the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** for providing process gas to the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**. For example, in at least some embodiments, the plurality of valves **201** can include four connected valves. The four connected valves can include a first pair of valves **207** and a second pair of valves **209**. Each of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** comprises a valve that has an output that is connected to the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** and a valve that has an output that is connected to a purge line **210**. Additionally, each valve of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** has an input that is connected to the one or more mass flow controllers **157**. The valves of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** can be the same as each other or different from each other.

(28) One or more additional valves can also be provided. For example, in at least some embodiments, a valve **211** and a valve **213** can be connected to the mass flow controllers **157** and provided on the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204**, respectively. The valve **211** and valve **213** are configured to control the entry of other types of process gasses which do not require to be fast switched.

(29) The purge line **210** can be connected to at least one of an input or output of the plurality of valves **201** and configured to purge the process gas from the first gas line **202** and the second gas

line **204**. For example, with respect to FIG. **2**, the purge line **210**, as noted above, is connected to an output of a valve of each of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209**. Other connection configurations of the purge line **210** are described in greater detail below.

(30) For example, FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram of the gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **3** is substantially identical to that of FIG. **2**. Accordingly, only those features of the gas flow delivery system **200** that are unique to FIG. **3** are described herein.

(31) For example, in FIG. **3**, the purge line **210** is connected to the output of a valve of each of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** and is also connected to the input of each valve of the first pair of valves and the second pair of valves **209**.

(32) Moreover, in FIG. **3** one or more mass flow meters are sized (e.g., $\frac{1}{4}$ inch, or larger or smaller) to be connected to the first gas line **202** and/or the second gas line **204**. For example, a first mass flow meter **314** and a second mass flow meter **316** are connected to the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204**, respectively. The first mass flow meter **314** and the second mass flow meter **316** are connected at a location adjacent the top delivery gas nozzle **135** and the side delivery gas nozzle **133**, e.g., after the first orifice flow restrictor **206** and the second orifice flow restrictor **208**. The first mass flow meter **314** and the second mass flow meter **316** are configured to measure a flow rate of the process gas respectively therethrough and transmit the measured flow rate to the controller **150**, which, in turn, can adjust the mass flow controllers **157** based on the measured flow rate.

(33) FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram of the gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **4** is substantially identical to that of FIGS. **2** and **3**. Accordingly, only those features of the gas flow delivery system **200** that are unique to FIG. **4** are described herein.

(34) For example, in FIG. **4**, as noted above, one or more of the above-described orifice flow restrictors can be replaced with one or more needle valves. For example, in FIG. **4**, one or both of the first orifice flow restrictor **206** and the second orifice flow restrictor **208** can be replaced with a respective needle valve. For example, as shown in FIG. **4**, both the first orifice flow restrictor **206** and the second orifice flow restrictor **208** can be replaced with a first needle valve **406** and a second needle valve **408**, respectively. Alternatively, any combination of orifice flow restrictors and more needle valves can be used.

(35) FIG. **5** is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **5** is similar to that of the gas flow delivery system **200**. Accordingly, only those features that are unique to the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **5** are described herein.

(36) For example, in FIG. **5** unlike the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209**, which comprise a valve having an input to the mass flow controller **157** and an output connected to the purge line **210**, the purge line **210** is directly connected to the one or more mass flow controllers (e.g., the mass flow controllers **157**). That is, the purge gas (e.g., dump) flows through an orifice restrictor **502**, thus providing a higher flow resistance to the purge gas and reducing the number of valves that are, typically, required. Accordingly, in at least some embodiments, instead of having the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209**, the gas flow delivery system **200** comprises a first valve **507** and a second valve **509**. Each of the first valve **507** and the second valve **509** include an input that is connected to one or more mass flow controllers (e.g., the mass flow controller **157**) and an output that is connected to the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204**.

(37) In the embodiment of FIG. **5**, one or more of the orifice flow restrictors or needle valves and mass flow meters can be connected to the first gas line and/or the second gas line. For example, in at least some embodiments, each of the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** can include one or more orifice flow restrictors/needle valves and mass flow meters. For example, in the

illustrated embodiment, the first needle valve **406** and the first mass flow meter **314** are shown connected to the first gas line **202**.

(38) FIG. **6** is a schematic diagram of a gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **6** is similar to the previously described gas flow delivery systems. Accordingly, only those features that are unique to the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **6** are described herein.

(39) FIG. **6** uses common dump valves for center and edge flows, thus reducing the number of valves required. For example, a valve **612** and a valve **614** are connected to the purge line **210**. Additionally, unlike the previously described gas flow delivery systems **200**, the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** of the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **6** are not connected to each other via the third gas line **203**. For example, the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIG. **6** comprises a first VCR fitting **607**, a second VCR fitting **608**, a third VCR fitting **609**, and a fourth VCR fitting **610**. The first VCR fitting **607** and the second VCR fitting **608** are connected to each other, the mass flow controller **157**, and the first gas line **202** to provide process gas to the top delivery gas nozzle **135**. Similarly, the third VCR fitting **609** and the fourth VCR fitting **610** are connected to each other, the mass flow controller **157**, and the second gas line **204** to provide process gas to the side delivery gas nozzle **133**, thus there is no need for a third gas line.

(40) FIG. **7** and FIG. **8** are schematic diagrams of the gas flow delivery system **200** in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIGS. **7** and **8** are similar to the previously described gas flow delivery systems. Accordingly, only those features that are unique to the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIGS. **7** and **8** are described herein.

(41) The gas flow delivery system **200** of FIGS. **7** and **8** are capable of providing different flow ratio distributions of process gasses to the top delivery gas nozzle **135** and the side delivery gas nozzle **133**. For example, the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204** are connected parallelly to an output of at least one of the plurality of valves, e.g., the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209**. Accordingly, each of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** comprises a valve that has a split output with one or more orifice flow restrictors or needle valves that are connected to the first gas line **202** and the second gas line **204**. For example, with respect to FIG. **7**, a valve **703** has a split output that connects to an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **702** (needle valve shown) connected to the first gas line **202** and an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **704** (needle valve shown) connected to the second gas line **204**. Similarly, a valve **705** has the split output that connects to an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **706** (needle valve shown) connected to the first gas line **202** and an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **708** (needle valve shown) connected to the second gas line **204**.

(42) Similarly, with respect to FIG. **8** a valve **803** has a split output that connects to an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **802** (needle valve shown) connected to either the first gas line **202** or an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve connected to the second gas line **204**. For illustrative purposes, the needle valve **802** is shown connected to the first gas line **202**. Likewise, a valve **805** has a split output that is connected to an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **804** (needle valve shown) connected to either the first gas line **202** or an orifice flow restrictor or needle valve **804** (needle valve shown) connected to the second gas line **204**. For illustrative purposes, the needle valve **804** is shown connected to the second gas line **204**.

(43) Additionally, with respect to FIGS. **7** and **8** each of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** comprises a valve that has an output that is connected to a purge line **210**. Additionally, each valve of the first pair of valves **207** and the second pair of valves **209** has an input that is connected to the one or more mass flow controllers **157**.

(44) FIG. **9** is a flowchart of a method **900** for processing a substrate in accordance with at least some embodiments of the present disclosure. For example, in at least some embodiments, the method **900** can be used during one or more plasma processes, e.g., a deposition process and/or an

etch process.

(45) For example, at **902**, the method includes supplying a process gas, via a first gas line (e.g., the first gas line **202**) connected to a top delivery gas nozzle (e.g., the top delivery gas nozzle **135**), a second gas line (e.g., the first gas line **202**) connected to a side delivery nozzle (e.g., side delivery gas nozzle **133**), and a plurality of valves (e.g., via one or more of the valve configurations of FIGS. 2-8) connected to the first gas line and the second gas line. The process gas is then supplied from the top delivery gas nozzle and the side delivery nozzle to a processing volume of a process chamber (e.g., the processing volume **106** of the processing chamber **100**).

(46) Next, at **904**, the method **900** includes controlling a gas flow rate of the process gas through at least one of the top delivery gas nozzle or the side delivery nozzle via at least one of a first orifice flow restrictor or a first needle valve connected to the first gas line or a second orifice flow restrictor or a second needle valve connected to the second gas line. For example, during an etching process, one or more of the above process gases can be used to etch various zones (or areas) of a substrate. For example, during a first etch cycle, one or more process gases can be provided into the processing volume **106** via, for example, the side delivery gas nozzle **133**. In at least some embodiments, one or more of the above-described process gases (e.g., O.sub.2, Cl.sub.2, CCl.sub.4O.sub.2, CO.sub.2, HCl, N.sub.2, NH.sub.3, N.sub.2O, NO.sub.2, O.sub.3, H.sub.2O, SF.sub.6 and the like) can be provided into the processing volume **106** via the side delivery gas nozzle **133**. For example, in at least some embodiments, the process gas used during the first etch cycle can be O.sub.2. The flow rate of the process gas through the side flow outlets **137** of the side delivery gas nozzle **133** is controlled by the one or more second orifice flow restrictors or a second needle valves connected to the second gas line. The etchants can be concentrated toward the side surfaces of the substrate (see FIG. **10C**). In at least some embodiments, during the first etch cycle the process time can be about 0.2 seconds to about 0.6 seconds, and in some embodiments, about 0.4 seconds. In at least some embodiments, the RF source power can be about 155 W to about 3000 W, and in some embodiments about 2000 W. In at least some embodiments, the RF bias power can be about 0 to 100 W (pulsed or continuous), and in some embodiments about 50 W (pulsed). In at least some embodiments, a pressure of about 20 mTorr to about 80 mTorr, and in some embodiments about 50 mTorr.

(47) Prior to performing a second etch cycle, the method **900** can comprise purging the process gas from the processing volume of the process chamber or from at least one of the first gas line and the second gas line via a purge line connected to at least one of an input or output of the plurality of valves.

(48) Additionally, at **904**, during a second etch cycle, one or more process gases can be provided into the processing volume **106** via, for example, the top delivery gas nozzle **135**. For example, in at least some embodiments, one or more of the above-described process gases (e.g., O.sub.2, Cl.sub.2, CCl.sub.4O.sub.2, CO.sub.2, HCl, N.sub.2, NH.sub.3, N.sub.2O, NO.sub.2, O.sub.3, H.sub.2O, SF.sub.6 and the like) can be provided into the processing volume **106** via the top delivery gas nozzle **135**. For example, in at least some embodiments, the process gas used during the second etch cycle can be SF.sub.6. The flow rate of the process gas through the center flow outlet **134** and the middle flow outlet **136** is controlled by the one or more first orifice flow restrictors or the first needle valves connected to the first gas line. The etchants can be concentrated toward a center surface and a middle surface of the substrate (see FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, respectively). In at least some embodiments, during the second etch cycle the process time can be about 0.2 seconds to about 0.6 seconds, and in some embodiments, about 0.4 seconds. In at least some embodiments, the RF source power can be about 155 W to about 3000 W, and in some embodiments about 2000 W. In at least some embodiments, the RF bias power can be about 0 to 100 W (pulsed or continuous), and in some embodiments about 50 W (pulsed). In at least some embodiments, a pressure of about 20 mTorr to about 80 mTorr, and in some embodiments about 50 mTorr.

(49) As noted above, when the same flow ratio (e.g., 50:50) distributions of process gases needs to be delivered to the top delivery gas nozzle **135** and the side delivery gas nozzle **133**, the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIGS. **2-6** can be used. When different flow ratio (e.g., 70:30) distributions of process gasses need to be delivered to the top delivery gas nozzle **135** and the side delivery gas nozzle **133**, however, the gas flow delivery system **200** of FIGS. **7** and **8** can be used.

(50) During **902** and **904** a mass flow meter connected to at least one of the first gas line **202** or the second gas line **204** can be used to measure the gas flow.

(51) While the foregoing is directed to embodiments of the present disclosure, other and further embodiments of the disclosure may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof.

Claims

1. An apparatus for processing a substrate, comprising: a processing chamber comprising a chamber body and a lid; a top delivery gas nozzle extending through the lid and configured to direct process gas toward a substrate support surface of a substrate support disposed within a processing volume of the processing chamber; a side delivery gas nozzle extending through the chamber body and configured to direct the process gas toward a side surface of the substrate support; a first gas line connected to the top delivery gas nozzle, a second gas line connected to the side delivery gas nozzle, and a plurality of valves that have outputs coupled to each other to connect to the first gas line and from the first gas line to the second gas line via a third gas line for providing process gas to the processing volume of the processing chamber; and at least one of: a first orifice flow restrictor or a first needle valve connected to the first gas line; or a second orifice flow restrictor or a second needle valve connected to the second gas line.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a mass flow meter connected to at least one of the first gas line or the second gas line.
3. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a purge line connected to at least one of an input or output of the plurality of valves and configured to purge the process gas from the first gas line and the second gas line.
4. The apparatus of claim 3, wherein the purge line is connected to the input of the plurality of valves and the purge line comprises a third orifice flow restrictor or a third needle valve.
5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first gas line and the second gas line are connected to each other at a location prior to the process gas entering the first orifice flow restrictor or the first needle valve connected to the first gas line or the second orifice flow restrictor or the second needle valve connected to the second gas line.
6. The apparatus of claim 5, wherein the plurality of valves comprises a first pair of valves and a second pair of valves.
7. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein each of the first pair of valves and the second pair of valves comprises a valve that has an output that is connected to the first gas line and the second gas line and a valve that has an output that is connected to a purge line.
8. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein each valve of the first pair of valves and the second pair of valves has an input that is connected to one or more mass flow controllers.
9. The apparatus of claim 8, wherein each of the first pair of valves and the second pair of valves includes an input that is connected to one or more mass flow controllers and an output that is connected to the first gas line and the second gas line, and wherein a purge line is directly connected to the one or more mass flow controllers.
10. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein an output of at least one of the plurality of valves is connected parallelly to the first gas line and the second gas line.
11. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the plurality of valves comprises a first pair of valves and a second pair of valves.
12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein each of the first pair of valves and the second pair of valves

comprises a valve that has a split output with the at least one of the first orifice flow restrictor or the first needle valve connected to the first gas line and the second orifice flow restrictor or the second needle valve connected to the second gas line.

13. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first gas line comprises the first orifice flow restrictor or the first needle valve and the second gas line comprises the second orifice flow restrictor or the second needle valve.

14. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the top delivery gas nozzle comprises a center flow outlet configured for center flow control and a middle flow outlet configured for middle flow control, and wherein the center flow outlet and the middle flow outlet are coupled to a gas panel through inlet ports.

15. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the side delivery gas nozzle comprises side flow outlets configured for side flow control, and wherein the side flow outlets are coupled to a gas panel through a corresponding inlet port.

16. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the processing chamber is configured to perform at least one of a plasma deposition process or an etch process.
